

D038

Educational Leadership Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In October, a leader checks early data on a new peer-tutoring program in a school with a 94% attendance rate, planning to adjust tutor training before winter. The program is funded by a local foundation. What kind of evaluation is this?

- A. Summative evaluation.
- B. A funder audit.
- C. Formative evaluation.
- D. Needs assessment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school board wants to decide in June whether to renew a two-year program. Which evaluation should the leader plan?

- A. A summative evaluation of the program's results.
- B. Only a count of sessions delivered.
- C. No evaluation, since two years is always enough to show success.
- D. A formative evaluation to adjust delivery.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A leader drafts a logic model for a family-literacy night program that won a district award last year. Elements include: two reading specialists and a \$5,000 budget; monthly workshops; 180 families attended; and parents reading with children more often at home. Where does “monthly workshops” belong?

- A. Outcomes.
- B. Inputs.
- C. Outputs.
- D. Activities.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A capstone report on a new attendance-coaching program states: “96 students met with a coach 8 times each, and staff rated the program highly.” The coaches were hired from a respected nonprofit. What is missing to show the program worked?

- A. Information about the nonprofit's reputation.
- B. More detail on how many meetings were held.
- C. Nothing; 8 meetings each proves the program worked.
- D. A measure of change in the students' attendance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is an outcome rather than an output?

- A. Chronic absence fell from 18% to 12%.
- B. Two coaches were hired.
- C. 40 coaching sessions were held.
- D. Every family received a letter.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A math program designed for 45 minutes daily showed no gains after one year at a school with a new principal and freshly painted halls. Logs show most classes used it about 15 minutes, twice a week. What should the leader conclude first?

- A. The change in principal caused the flat results.
- B. The program does not work and should be dropped.
- C. Gains were likely hidden, so the program works.
- D. The results cannot fairly judge the program, because it was not implemented as designed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A leader in a district of 12 schools wants to know why teachers in some buildings stopped using a new behavior plan. The district uses a new data dashboard. Which method best fits the question?

- A. Only quantitative methods, since they are always more rigorous.
- B. Qualitative interviews or focus groups with teachers.
- C. A count of referrals from the dashboard.
- D. A pretest-posttest of student scores.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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8.

Reading scores at one school rose 8 points the year a new phonics program started, the same year the state raised teacher pay. Similar nearby schools without the program rose 7 points. How much of the gain is fairly credited to the program?

- A. 7 points.
- B. About 1 point.
- C. 15 points.
- D. All 8 points.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students in a program gained 10 points. The evaluator credits 4 points to the program after comparing with a similar group. How many points did the comparison group gain?

- A. 4 points.
- B. 14 points.
- C. 6 points.
- D. 10 points.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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10.

A family survey with a 22% return rate, sent by a new online platform, suggests parents dislike the new homework policy. What should the leader do before recommending the policy be dropped?

- A.** Check the finding against other sources, such as a parent focus group and homework completion data.
- B.** Switch survey platforms.
- C.** Drop the policy, since parents clearly dislike it.
- D.** Resend the same survey on the same platform.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A leader's finding is supported by test data, classroom observations, and student interviews that all point the same way. What does this give the finding?

- A.** Generalizability to all schools.
- B.** Stronger credibility through triangulation.
- C.** Weaker credibility, since the sources could conflict.
- D.** Proof that the program caused the results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

The school board must decide in March whether to fund a mentoring program for next year. A capstone candidate who enjoys statistics plans a detailed report for June. The board chair has served for ten years. What change would most improve the evaluation's use?

- A.** Report only to the board chair.
- B.** Keep the June date so the data are complete.
- C.** Meet with board members early to set questions and deliver key findings before March.
- D.** Add more statistical tests to the June report.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

In October, a leader checks early data on a new peer-tutoring program in a school with a 94% attendance rate, planning to adjust tutor training before winter. ~~The program is funded by a local foundation.~~ What kind of evaluation is this?

Target word: type of evaluation **Decides:** Mid-program data used to improve the program.

A	Inverted operation	Summative judges results at the end for a continue/stop decision.
B	Camouflage	The funding source does not decide the evaluation type.
C	Correct	Done during the program to improve it.
D	Adjacent category	Needs assessment comes before a program to define the problem.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A school board wants to decide in June whether to renew a two-year program. Which evaluation should the leader plan?

Target word: choose the type from the decision **Decides:** End-of-program judgment for a renewal decision.

A	Correct	A continue/stop decision needs an end judgment of outcomes.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out outcomes, which renewal depends on.
C	Absolute language	Time alone does not show results.
D	Inverted operation	Improvement during the program does not answer a renewal decision.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A leader drafts a logic model for a family-literacy night program ~~that won a district award last year.~~ Elements include: two reading specialists and a \$5,000 budget; monthly workshops; 180 families attended; and parents reading with children more often at home. Where does “monthly workshops” belong?

Target word: sort one element **Decides:** Workshops are what the program does.

A	Confusion set	Outcomes are changes such as more reading at home.
B	Adjacent category	Inputs are resources like staff and budget.
C	Confusion set	Outputs count delivery, such as 180 families attending.
D	Correct	Workshops are the program's actions.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A capstone report on a new attendance-coaching program states: “96 students met with a coach 8 times each, and staff rated the program highly.” ~~The coaches were hired from a respected nonprofit.~~ What is missing to show the program worked?

Target word: what shows effect **Decides:** Meetings are outputs; an outcome is a change in attendance.

A	Camouflage	Reputation does not show results.
B	Inverted operation	Adds more output data, not outcomes.
C	Absolute language	Participation is not evidence of change.
D	Correct	Outcomes show change; counts of meetings do not.

5. Answer A Concept 3 · transfer

Which of these is an outcome rather than an output?

Target word: pick the outcome **Decides:** Outcome = a change in people or results.

A	Correct	A measured change in behavior.
B	Adjacent category	Staff are inputs.
C	Confusion set	A count of delivery is an output.
D	Confusion set	A delivery count, not a change.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A math program designed for 45 minutes daily showed no gains after one year at a school ~~with a new principal and freshly painted halls~~. Logs show most classes used it about 15 minutes, twice a week. What should the leader conclude first?

Target word: what the result means **Decides:** The program was delivered far below design.

A	Camouflage	Leadership change is not the evidence at hand.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the fidelity data.
C	Inverted operation	No evidence supports a hidden effect.
D	Correct	Low fidelity means the program itself was not really tested.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A leader ~~in a district of 12 schools~~ wants to know why teachers in some buildings stopped using a new behavior plan. ~~The district uses a new data dashboard.~~ Which method best fits the question?

Target word: method for a why question **Decides:** “Why” calls for understanding reasons.

A	Absolute language	Rigor depends on fit to the question.
B	Correct	Qualitative methods explain how and why.
C	Camouflage	Counts show how much, not why.
D	Adjacent category	Measures change in students, not teacher reasons.

8. Answer B Concept 6

Reading scores at one school rose 8 points the year a new phonics program started, ~~the same year the state raised teacher pay~~. Similar nearby schools without the program rose 7 points. How much of the gain is fairly credited to the program?

Target word: effect net of comparison **Decides:** Compare to similar schools: $8 - 7 = 1$ point.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the comparison schools' gain.
B	Correct	8 minus the 7-point gain seen without the program.
C	Inverted operation	Adds the comparison gain instead of subtracting.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the comparison schools.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

Students in a program gained 10 points. The evaluator credits 4 points to the program after comparing with a similar group. How many points did the comparison group gain?

Target word: solve for the comparison gain **Decides:** Program effect = program gain – comparison gain.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the program effect.
B	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting.
C	Correct	$10 - 4 = 6$.
D	Dropped element	The program group's total gain.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A family survey with a 22% return rate, ~~sent by a new online platform~~, suggests parents dislike the new homework policy. What should the leader do before recommending the policy be dropped?

Target word: confirming a finding **Decides:** One low-response source needs confirming.

A	Correct	Triangulation confirms with independent sources.
B	Camouflage	The platform is not what limits the finding.
C	Absolute language	Treats one partial source as certain.
D	Adjacent category	Repeats one source rather than adding different ones.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

A leader's finding is supported by test data, classroom observations, and student interviews that all point the same way. What does this give the finding?

Target word: effect of agreement across sources **Decides:** Multiple independent sources agree.

A	Adjacent category	Generalizing depends on sampling, not triangulation.
B	Correct	Agreement across methods strengthens the conclusion.
C	Inverted operation	They agree, which strengthens the finding.
D	Absolute language	Triangulation raises confidence but does not prove cause.

12. Answer C Concept 8

The school board must decide in March whether to fund a mentoring program for next year. A capstone candidate ~~who enjoys statistics~~ plans a detailed report for June. ~~The board chair has served for ten years.~~ What change would most improve the evaluation's use?

Target word: match evaluation to users' decision **Decides:** The decision is in March; the report is in June.

A	Adjacent category	One person is not the full set of intended users.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the decision date.
C	Correct	Involving users and matching timing makes findings usable.
D	Camouflage	More analysis does not fix timing.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Formative vs. summative evaluation	Formative evaluation happens during a program to improve it; summative evaluation judges results at the end to decide whether to continue, expand, or stop.	Calling any mid-year check a summative judgment, or waiting until the end to fix problems.	When the evaluation happens and what decision it feeds.
2	Logic model components	Inputs (resources) feed activities (what the program does), which produce outputs (counts of what was delivered), which lead to outcomes (changes in people).	Mixing up activities, outputs, and outcomes.	A list of program elements to sort into a model.
3	Outputs vs. outcomes	Outputs count what was delivered (sessions held, people served); outcomes measure change in knowledge, behavior, or results.	Reporting attendance as proof a program worked.	A success claim based on a count of participation.
4	Implementation fidelity before effect	Before judging whether a program works, check that it was delivered as designed; weak results from a program barely delivered say little about the program.	Dropping a program for poor results without checking whether it was ever really run.	Disappointing results plus a hint that delivery was partial.
5	Question drives method	Choose quantitative methods to measure how much or whether a change occurred, qualitative methods to understand how or why, and mixed methods when both are needed.	Picking a survey or interviews first and then fitting the question to the tool.	An evaluation question beginning with how much, whether, how, or why.
6	Comparison needed to attribute effect	To credit a program with a change, compare against a baseline or a similar group that did not get the program.	Crediting the program for any post-program gain.	A gain reported with no comparison group or baseline.
7	Triangulation	Confirm a finding with two or more independent data sources or methods before acting on it.	Treating one survey as the whole story.	A conclusion resting on a single data source.
8	Utilization-focused stakeholder involvement	Involve intended users of the evaluation early so questions, timing, and reporting match the decisions they must make.	Designing the evaluation alone and handing a long report to decision makers at the end.	Who will use the findings and when.

Course scope (public description): Educational Leadership Capstone serves as the culminating experience of this degree program, uniting content area knowledge with the execution of a problem-based learning project. Under the guidance of program faculty, candidates will apply their data literacy and research skills authentically and to topics appropriate to the candidate's degree program and future career goals. Projects will include action research or program evaluation and the qualitative or quantitative research methods necessitated by the project's purpose. Prerequisites include Data Literacy and Educational Inquiry, as well as all content area courses and field experiences prescribed in one's area of study. This course is designed to be taken after successful completion of all

courses with the exception of Educational Inquiry, which may be taken concurrently.